

Mat Lowery

Senior Platform Engineer | Kubernetes, Cloud Infrastructure, Developer Productivity · Denver, CO

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ABOUT

I build internal platforms and infrastructure for engineers who have better things to worry about. A decade at eBay's scale — Kubernetes control planes, etcd, DNS, container registries, federation — taught me that the gap between 'it works' and 'it's easy to operate' is where most of the real work lives.

IMPACT

- **\$200K+ Annual vendor cost eliminated:** Led container registry migration from proprietary to open-source infrastructure.
- **75% DNS query volume reduction:** Tuned CoreDNS behavior and contributed upstream improvements.
- **50% Pager volume reduction:** Prioritized SLO signals and follow-up fixes with the APIServer SRE team.
- **2x+ Container image upload rate:** Patched container registry upload code and tuned chunk size for faster pushes.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Go, Python, Shell
- **Platform and Kubernetes:** Docker, Kubernetes, APIServer, CoreDNS, DNS, OpenStack, Operators, Federation, OCI container registries, Quay, API Priority & Fairness, etcd
- **Infrastructure and delivery:** GitOps, Prometheus, Grafana, Tekton, Linux, Release automation, Disaster recovery
- **Tools:** Jira, Confluence, PagerDuty
- **Practices:** Mentoring, Technical writing

WORK EXPERIENCE

eBay — Senior MTS, Software Engineer (Senior Staff equivalent)

Feb 2022 – Apr 2026

- Owned and operated Kubernetes control planes, etcd, DNS, federation, container registry, and platform automation at one of the industry's largest private Kubernetes fleets
- Led a container registry migration that eliminated six figures per year in vendor cost
- Patched container registry upload code and tuned chunk size for 2x+ faster pushes
- Improved APIServer reliability with SRE partners, reducing pager volume 50%
- Rolled out operator-based automation across 100 etcd clusters
- Sharded federation syncing for multi-year scale runway

eBay — MTS 2, Software Engineer (Staff equivalent)

May 2016 – Feb 2022

- Built and operated eBay's Kubernetes platform including the control planes themselves on eBay compute and additionally cluster DNS, cluster federation, release automation, security hardening, and production support at 60+ clusters, 30K+ nodes, and 160K+ pods
- Tuned CoreDNS to reduce query volume 75%, increase QPS 4x, and cut CPU and memory by 80% and 50%
- Built GitOps-based federation release and credential rotation automation

eBay — MTS 2, Software Engineer (Staff equivalent)

Nov 2013 – Apr 2016

- Developed database-as-a-service for MySQL, MongoDB, Couchbase, and Cassandra on eBay infrastructure
- Hardened database failover tooling by raising test coverage from 0% to 75% with minimal core-code changes
- Contributed code, reviews, bugs, documentation, and infrastructure debugging across OpenStack Trove and related OpenStack community projects

X.commerce — MTS 1, Software Engineer (Senior equivalent)

Apr 2012 – Nov 2013

- Built and operated private OpenStack infrastructure on bare metal, including Nova, Keystone, Glance, Swift, and Cinder
- Led replacement of floating-IP failover with Corosync and Pacemaker clustering for more robust VM high availability

Pentaho — Senior Software Engineer

Oct 2006 – Apr 2012

- Built core backend platform features for business intelligence products, including secured artifact repository architecture, security infrastructure, and open-source integrations
- Led product security components and wrote public documentation used by customer-facing teams
- Contributed to Spring Security, Apache Jackrabbit, and CloudInit

Wyndham Worldwide — Application Software Developer

Oct 2003 – Sep 2006

- Built enterprise web application infrastructure for customer-facing systems, with focus on security, shared services, reusable application layers, and user-management services across Active Directory and Oracle user stores

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EDUCATION

University of Central Florida — Master's Degree, Computer Science 2001 – 2003

University of Central Florida — Bachelor's Degree, Computer Science 1998 – 2001

OPEN SOURCE

CoreDNS — [CoreDNS Kubernetes plugin namespace performance](#) : Merged a Kubernetes plugin change that replaced namespace list scans with cache lookups and reduced namespace cache memory for clusters with 10K+ namespaces.

Gophercloud — [Gophercloud reauth deadlock analysis](#) : Reported and isolated a reauthentication deadlock with a minimal reproducer and lock-level diagnosis.

Quay — [RadosGW storage provider chunk sizing](#) : Opened a Quay storage provider change adding `minimum\_chunk\_size\_mb` configurability for RadosGW uploads.

Kubernetes — [Kubelet pod status reason/message bug](#) : Filed a SIG Node bug showing how kubelet could copy `status.reason` and `status.message` across pod phase transitions.

OpenStack Trove — [OpenStack Trove cluster task manager](#) : Merged the cluster task manager implementation for OpenStack Trove, adding the orchestration layer for database cluster lifecycle work.

OpenStack Trove — [Service endpoints from catalog](#) : Merged a Trove service-catalog change that moved service endpoint discovery away from hard-coded URL configuration.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

sticky-kubeconfig — Shell helper for keeping a unique kubeconfig per terminal session.

executable-image — Shell tooling to run Docker images as executables.